RR-C-430a
October 31, 1966

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. RR-C-00430 (ARMY-MO)
July 29, 1964 and
MIL-C-12122B
August 22, 1962

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLIMBER SET, TREE AND POLE: STEEL, INTERCHANGEABLE GAFF, W/NYLON-NEOPRENE COATED STRAPS

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers an adjustable tree and pole climber set with interchangeable gaffs and nylon neoprene coated straps.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130—Identification Marking of U.S. Military Property.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Publication:

E 138—Wet Magnetic Particle Inspection.

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(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race St., Philadelphia, Pa., 19103.)

Edison Electric Institute Specification (EEIS) Publication:

AP-2—Specifications for Linemen's Climbing Equipment.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Edison Electric Institute, 420 Lexington Ave., New York, N. Y., 10017.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. The climber set shall conform to one of the types shown in figure 1 and to EEIS AP-2, except that the straps shall conform to figures 2 and 3, and the calf pad assembly shall conform to figure 4. The climbers shall be adjustable from 14-3/4 to 19-1/4 inches in increments of 1/4 inch.

3.2 Material. Material shall be as specified in EEIS AP-2, except as specified herein for straps.

3.2.1 *Leg irons.* Leg irons shall be of forged steel and shall conform to the required shapes of the finished pieces.

3.2.2 *Strap material.* The fabric used for the climber straps shall consist of four plies of plain weave, close-woven, nylon cloth of 50 by 25 thread count folded so that no raw edges are exposed. The cloth shall be impregnated or coated with neoprene and vulcanized so that the plies are not separable except by chemical means or by applying a tensile force of at least 125 pounds per inch of width. The 4-ply fabric used for the straps shall have a breaking strength of not less than 1,400 pounds for a section free from buckle holes. The fabric shall have a buckle-holding strength of not less than 300 pounds without evidence of failure and shall tear with the direction of the load application when tested to failure.

3.3 Gaffs. One set of pole gaffs and one set of tree gaffs shall be furnished with each climber set. The tree gaffs and the pole gaffs shall be interchangeable.

3.4 Magnetic particle requirements. When the gaffs and leg shanks are subjected to the magnetic particle test specified in 4.4.2.1, there shall be no evidence of cracks or other discontinuities.

3.5 Identification marking.

3.5.1 *Military.* The climber set shall be identified in accordance with MIL-STD-130.

3.5.2 *Civil agencies.* The climber set shall be permanently and clearly marked with the manufacturer's name, or a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily identified.

3.6 Instruction sheet. An instruction sheet covering gaff replacement procedure and proper sharpening procedure shall be included with each climber set.

3.7 Workmanship. All parts and components of the climber set shall be free of forging laps, seams, cold shuts, visible cracks, and cross grinding marks. Cutting edges of the gaffs shall be ground smooth.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Classification of inspection. Inspection shall be classified as follows:

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(a) Quality conformance inspection of the climber set.
(b) Inspection of preparation for delivery.

4.3 Quality conformance inspection.

4.3.1 *Examination.* Each climber set shall be examined as specified in 4.4.1. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.2 *Tests.*

4.3.2.1 *Individual.* Each climber set shall be tested as specified in EEIS AP-2 and 4.4.2.1. Failure of either test shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.2.2 *Samples.* Three specimens of straps without buckles or buckle holes and three specimens of straps with buckles from each lot shall be tested as specified in 4.4.2.2 through 4.4.2.4. A lot shall consist of all straps offered for delivery at the same time plus the quantity required for destructive tests. Failure of any test shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4 Inspection procedure.

4.4.1 *Examination.* Each climber set shall be examined for the following defects:

101. Tree and pole gaffs not interchangeable.
102. Dimensions not in accordance with the figures.
103. Material not as specified.
104. Presence of forging laps, seams, or cold shuts in the material.
105. Gaffs not free from cross grinding marks, or cutting edges not ground smooth.
106. Presence of visible cracks.
107. Missing parts, components, or instruction sheet.
108. Incomplete or incorrect assembly.

4.4.2 *Tests.*

4.4.2.1 *Wet magnetic particle test.* Each gaff and leg shank shall be tested in accordance with ASTM E 138. The direction of the magnetic field shall be both circular and longitudinal. The sequence of operation shall be continuous. All parts shall be demagnetized after inspection. Evidence of cracks or other discontinuities shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2.2 *Strap test.* Three specimens each of straps without buckle holes shall be tested for tensile breaking strength. Each specimen shall be secured in a testing machine and a load shall be applied with a steady pull at a rate of 4 inches per minute until the strap breaks. Failure of any specimen to withstand a minimum force of 1,400 pounds shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2.3 *Strap material test.* Three specimens of straps without buckle holes shall be tested for ply separation or "peel" strength. Each specimen shall be cut so that purchase may be made on any two adjacent plies and a tensile force applied in opposite directions so as to test the "peel" strength of the neoprene coating. Each specimen shall be secured in a testing machine and a load shall be applied with a steady pull at a rate of 4 inches per minute until the plies are separated. Failure of any specimen to withstand a minimum force of 125 pounds per inch of width shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2.4 *Buckled strap test.* Three specimens of straps with buckle holes shall be tested by placing the strap in the buckle with the buckle tongue through the strap buckle hole. The strap and buckle shall be placed in the testing machine, and a load shall be applied with a steady pull at a rate of 4 inches per minute until failure occurs. A buckled strap holding strength of less than 300 pounds or evidence of tearing in any direction other than in the direction of the load application shall constitute failure of this test.

4.5 Inspection of preparation for delivery.

4.5.1 *Quality conformance inspection of pack.*

4.5.1.1 *Unit of product.* For the purpose of inspection, a completed pack prepared for shipment shall be considered a unit of product.

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4.5.1.2 *Sampling.* Sampling for examination shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1.3 *Examination.* Samples selected in accordance with 4.5.1.2 shall be examined for the following defects. AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

109.	Materials, methods, and containers not as specified for levels A and B. Each incorrect material or container, and each incorrect method shall not constitute one defect.
110.	Gross weight exceeds the weight limitations of the box for level A.
111.	Boxes exceeding 250 pounds not modified with skids for level A.
112.	Strapping not zinc coated for level A.
113.	Strapping not placed adjacent to the skids on modified boxes for level A.
114.	Gross weight or size exceeds the limitation of the box specification for level B.
115.	Slotted style boxes not waterproofed as specified for level B.
116.	Marking illegible, incorrect, or incomplete.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Each complete climber set with instruction sheet shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-5.

5.1.2 *Level B.* Each complete climber set with instruction sheet shall be preserved in accordance with MIL-P-116, method III, using a box conforming to PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 125, style optional.

5.1.3 *Level C.* Each complete climber set with instruction sheet shall be packaged in the supplier's container or in a commercial container adequate to afford protection against damage from the supplier to the initial destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* The climber sets, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-621, class 2, style optional; or PPP-B-601, overseas type, style optional. The gross weight of each box shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Boxes exceeding 250 pounds gross weight shall be modified with skids, in accordance with the applicable box specification. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification. Strapping shall be zinc coated and, on modified boxes, placed adjacent to the skids.

5.2.2 *Level B.* The climber sets, preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in close fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s, style optional. The gross weight or size shall not exceed the limitations of the box specification. Slotted style boxes shall be waterproofed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3. *Level C.* The climber sets preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in containers complying with rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required in the contract or purchase order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required in the contract or purchase order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Climber sets are intended for use in ascending and descending trees and poles.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted here-

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in and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Levels of preservation, packaging, and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2). Level B preservation, packaging, and packing is intended to provide economical but limited protection and should be specified only when it is determined the climber sets will be held in covered storage.

MILITARY INTEREST:

Custodians:

Army—MO(ERDL)
Navy—YD
Air Force—84

Review activities:

Army—MO, SM, MU
Navy—YD
Air Force—None

User activities:

Army—EL
Navy—MC
Air Force—84

CIVIL AGENCY INTEREST:

GSA-FSS

Preparing activity:

Army—MO(ERDL)

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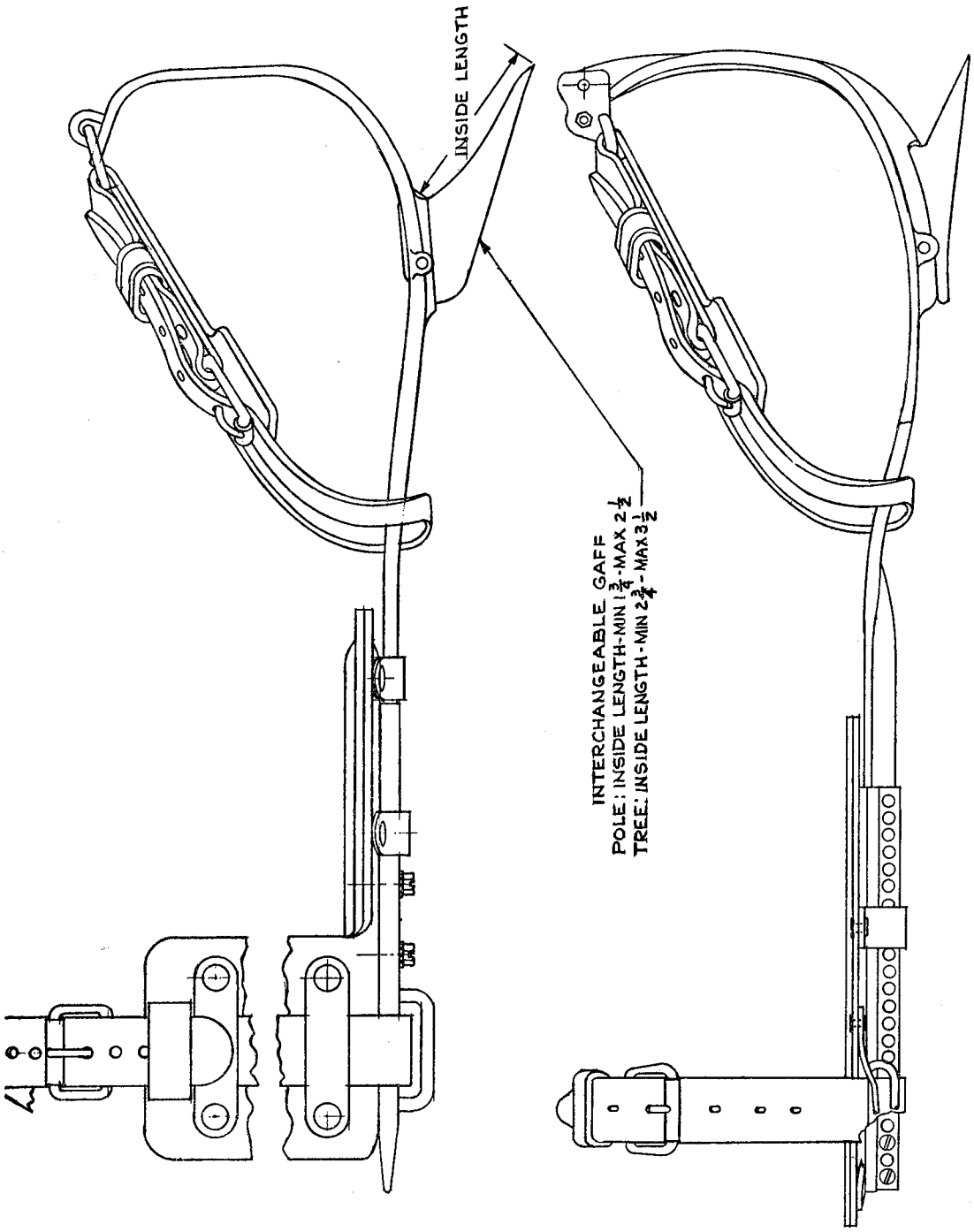
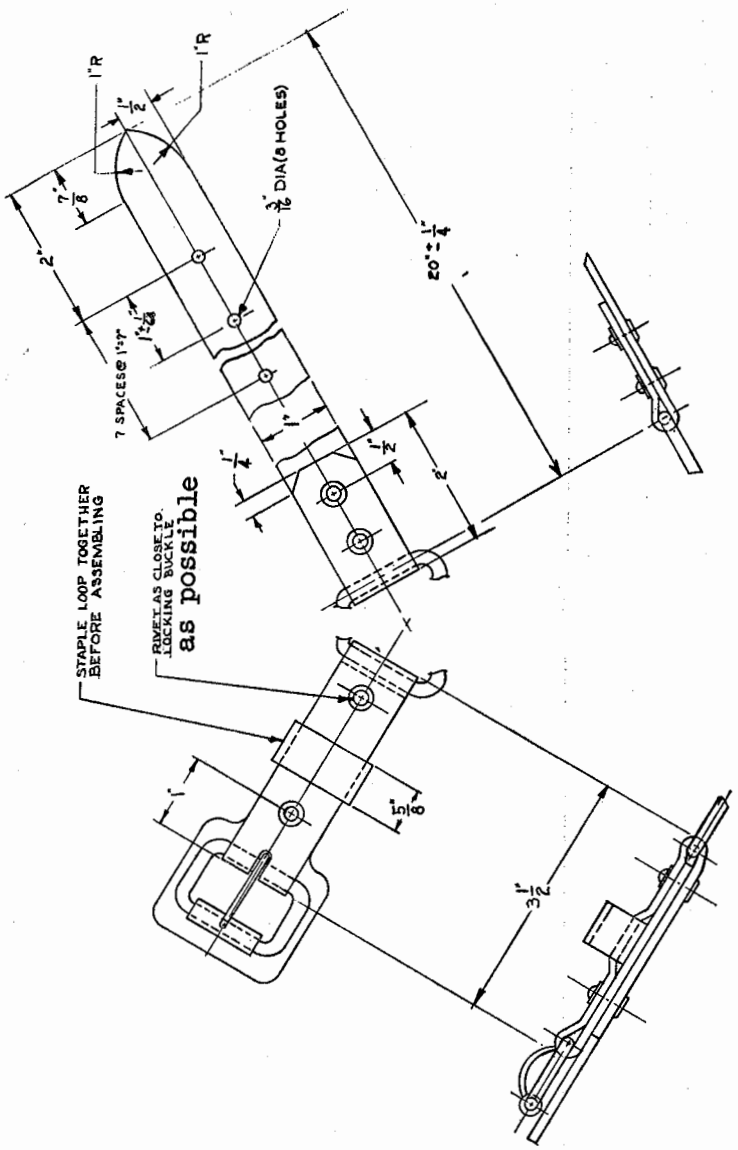


FIGURE 1 - CLIMBER SET, TREE AND POLE: STEEL INTERCHANGEABLE GAFF, WITH NYLON NEOPRENE COATED STRAPS, TYPICAL

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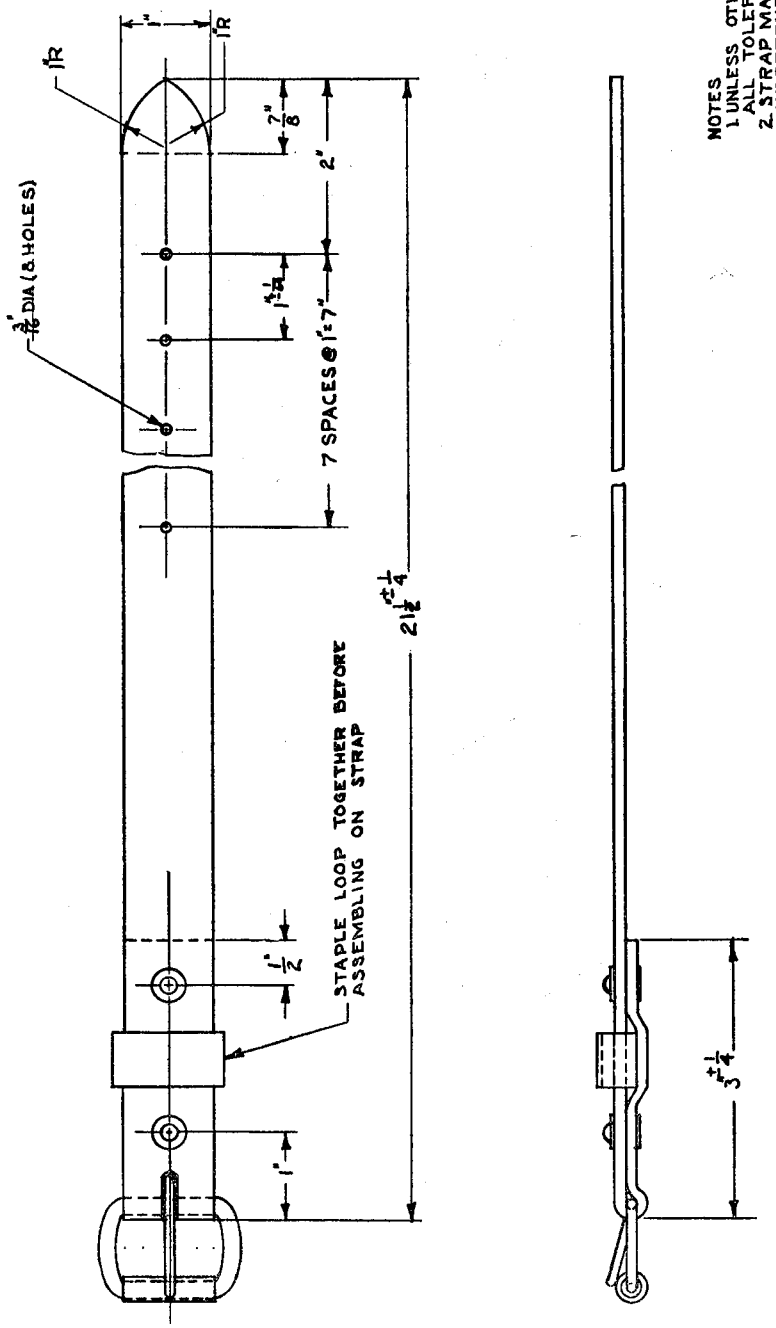


Notes:
1. Unless otherwise specified all tolerances are plus or minus 1/32 inch.
2. Strap material: Nylon neoprene coated.

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FIGURE 2- ANKLE STRAP ASSEMBLY

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NOTES
1. UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED ALL TOLERANCES ARE ± 1/8".
2. STRAP MATERIAL: NYLON, NEOPRENE COATED.

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FIGURE 3 - CALF STRAP ASSEMBLY

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